

virtual money tree and it didn't care what I was doing. Whether I was watching *Jerry Springer* or jet skiing in Jamaica, the system was built to be its own machine—a living, breathing entity that did the dirty work for me. My system was a surrogate and traded its time. I owned my time instead of time owning me.

PASSIVE INCOME: THE HOLY GRAIL TO RETIREMENT

The buzzword in moneymaking circles is “passive income”—earning income while not working. While retired, I receive checks every month like clockwork and I don't lift a finger. Passive income is a successful divorce from the “work-for-money” equation indigenous to the Slowlane. The beauty of passive income is it doesn't care if you're 20 years old or 80. If your monthly income exceeds your lifestyle expenses including taxes, guess what? You're retired!

The Fastlane Roadmap is engineered for two purposes. It's engineered to create a passive income stream to the excess of your expenses and lifestyle desires, and to make financial freedom a reality, exclusive of age.

TO BREAK TIME IS TO GROW A MONEY TREE

Mom convinced me it was true. “We can't afford that, do you think money grows on trees?” She was wrong. Money grows on trees if you own a money tree. And, you can own one if you know how and where to get the seeds. Money trees are business systems that survive on their own. They require periodic support and nurturing but survive on their own, creating a surrogate for your time-for-money trade.

A few years ago, I was in Vegas and I lost nearly \$2,000 gambling. After retreating to my hotel room with my tail between my legs, I realized, why fret? I lost \$2,000. On that day, my money tree, my Internet company I created, earned \$6,000. While I gambled (or slept, swam, or ate) my blooming money tree bore fruit.

A money tree is a business system, and it's the Fastlane roadmap's Main Street. Money trees create passive income streams **BEFORE** you “officially” retire. Yes, you can experience the destination of retirement and financial freedom without actually being retired. This is akin to taking a vacation to the South Pacific and magically bypassing the nine-hour plane ride.

MONEY TREE SEEDLINGS: A FASTLANE BUSINESS

Not all businesses are Fastlane, and many of them can't be transformed into money trees. Misled by gurus and life coaches, wannabe entrepreneurs are steered astray under the lure of “Be your own boss” and “Do what you love!” and head down a path of business servitude that is identical to being indentured to a job.

It is Jillian's dream to be her own boss. After a 13-year career on Wall Street, Jillian quits her financial adviser job and buys a well-known deli franchise. She liquidates half of her 401K to pay for franchise fees and startup